



MYHISTAMATE GUIDE

# Meal & symptom *journal.*

Why it pays to write things down — and how to see the patterns behind your symptoms. With ready-to-print sheets to fill in daily.

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FROM ME, TO YOU

Only when I started writing everything down did my reactions begin to make sense. This journal also gets you ready for the app, but it helps on its own too — even on paper.



*With love, Cătălina*  
FOUNDER, MYHISTAMATE

## 1 What the journal shows you



### The sum, not a single food

Histamine builds up from several sources. A journal shows the full picture of a day, not just one meal.



### The time lag

A reaction can appear hours or even a day after the trigger. Noted in the moment, the link becomes visible; from memory, it gets lost.



### Repeating patterns

The same combinations that recur before symptoms only emerge once you have several days recorded, side by side.

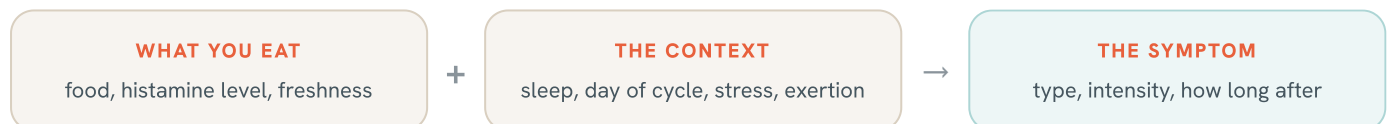


### Comparable data

The same categories, filled in consistently, let you compare days with one another and have a concrete conversation with your doctor.

## 2 How symptoms connect

A symptom rarely comes from a single cause. Usually it is the result of three things adding up:



### PATTERN EXAMPLE

*„Migraines usually show up about 1 day after fish meals, especially on days 1-3 of the cycle.“* — a pattern like this is not visible in a single day; it emerges from several records placed end to end.

**Note.** This material is for personal journaling and observing your own patterns. It does not provide a diagnosis and does not replace medical advice.

### 3 The categories

#### The food journal

**The meal** Time, type (breakfast / lunch / dinner / snack) and a short description — what you ate.  
FOR EACH ONE

**Ingredients** The main ingredients, each with its level: ● Low ● Medium ● High  
HISTAMINE LEVEL

#### The symptom journal

**The type** One or more:  
WHAT YOU FEEL

Migraine Itching Bloating Palpitations Congestion Flushing Fatigue  
Cramps Nausea Dizziness Rhinitis / stuffy nose Anxiety

*This list is a guide, by way of example — everyone personalises their symptoms to fit their own patterns.*

**Intensity** **Mild** (doesn't affect you) · **Medium** (slows you down) · **Severe** (stops you). Use the same logic every time.  
ONE LEVEL ONLY

**The context** **Sleep** (hours) · **Day of cycle** (if relevant) · **Digestion** (Bristol scale, type 1–7).  
OF THE DAY

### 4 How to use the journal

- 1 Log it in real time.** Meals as you eat them, symptoms as they appear — not from memory in the evening.
- 2 Fill in the daily context.** Sleep, cycle and digestion turn isolated data into patterns.
- 3 Be consistent.** The same categories and the same intensity scale, day after day.
- 4 Re-read weekly.** Look for combinations that recur before symptoms — and the time lag between them.

#### TIP

Use the next page for meals (one per day) and the last page for symptoms. The symptom page has two sheets — print it as many times as you need.

Date \_\_\_\_\_

Day of cycle \_\_\_\_\_

Sleep (hours) \_\_\_\_\_

| TIME | MEAL TYPE | WHAT I ATE | MAIN INGREDIENTS | LEVEL (L/M/H) |
|------|-----------|------------|------------------|---------------|
|      |           |            |                  |               |
|      |           |            |                  |               |
|      |           |            |                  |               |
|      |           |            |                  |               |
|      |           |            |                  |               |
|      |           |            |                  |               |
|      |           |            |                  |               |

● **L** — Low    ● **M** — Medium    ● **H** — High

**REMEMBER**

The details matter — cooking method, freshness and quantity all affect the histamine level (fresh fish differs from canned).

For each episode, fill in what you feel, how intense it is and the context of the day. This page has two sheets — print it as many times as you need.

**SYMPTOM SHEET**

Date \_\_\_\_\_ Time \_\_\_\_\_

## WHAT I FEEL (TICK ALL THAT APPLY)

- |                                       |                                       |                                   |                                       |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Migraine     | <input type="checkbox"/> Itching      | <input type="checkbox"/> Bloating | <input type="checkbox"/> Palpitations |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Congestion   | <input type="checkbox"/> Flushing     | <input type="checkbox"/> Fatigue  | <input type="checkbox"/> Cramps       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Nausea       | <input type="checkbox"/> Dizziness    | <input type="checkbox"/> Rhinitis | <input type="checkbox"/> Anxiety      |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Other: _____ | <input type="checkbox"/> Other: _____ |                                   |                                       |

*The symptoms above are a guide — add whatever you feel under 'Other' and keep the same names every time.*

**INTENSITY**

- |                                                        |                                                      |                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Mild</b> doesn't affect me | <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Medium</b> slows me down | <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Severe</b> stops me |
|--------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|

**TODAY'S CONTEXT****Sleep**

how many hours

**Day of cycle**

if relevant

**Digestion**

Bristol 1-7

**NOTES**

----- CUT OUT / RE-PRINT -----

## SYMPTOM SHEET

Date \_\_\_\_\_ Time \_\_\_\_\_

### WHAT I FEEL (TICK ALL THAT APPLY)

- |                                       |                                    |                                       |                                       |
|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Migraine     | <input type="checkbox"/> Itching   | <input type="checkbox"/> Bloating     | <input type="checkbox"/> Palpitations |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Congestion   | <input type="checkbox"/> Flushing  | <input type="checkbox"/> Fatigue      | <input type="checkbox"/> Cramps       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Nausea       | <input type="checkbox"/> Dizziness | <input type="checkbox"/> Rhinitis     | <input type="checkbox"/> Anxiety      |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Other: _____ |                                    | <input type="checkbox"/> Other: _____ |                                       |

*The symptoms above are a guide — add whatever you feel under ‘Other’ and keep the same names every time.*

### INTENSITY

- |                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/>  <b>Mild</b> doesn't affect me | <input type="checkbox"/>  <b>Medium</b> slows me down | <input type="checkbox"/>  <b>Severe</b> stops me |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

### TODAY'S CONTEXT

#### Sleep

how many hours

#### Day of cycle

if relevant

#### Digestion

Bristol 1–7

### NOTES